

```
$ yum install MariaDB MariaDB-server -y
```

And if you have downloaded the specific version in the *.tar.gz* format, then you can install and configure it as per your requirements. A few specific configurations that I have defined are listed here.

### Standard installation:

- Copy the tar file to */usr/local/mysql* (the generic default location on most platforms)
- Untar/unpack the distribution
- Run the installer script *./scripts/mysql\_install\_db --user=mysql*

**Installing MariaDB as the root user:** If you have root access, then you should install MariaDB with the user and group as 'mysql'. This will also provide compatibility with MySQL. The installation steps are as follows:

```
$ groupadd mysql
$ useradd -g mysql mysql
$ cd /usr/local
$ tar -xvzf <MariaDB.tar.gz file>
$ cd mysql
$ ./scripts/mysql_install_db --user=mysql
$ chown -R root
$ chown -R mysql data
```

**Replacing MySQL with MariaDB:** It is very easy to replace an installed MySQL with MariaDB. You need not even run the *mysql\_install\_db* script, but just follow the steps shown below:

- Stop the MySQL instance
- MariaDB will find the path to your data directory from */etc/my.cnf*
- Start the MySQL daemon again from MariaDB:

```
$ ./bin/mysqld_safe --user=mysql &
```

Or specify the *config* file location:

```
$ ./bin/mysqld_safe --defaults-file=~/.my.cnf --user=mysql &
```

And finally, modify the *\$PATH* variable so that you can invoke binaries:

```
Export PATH=$PATH:/usr/local/mysql/bin/
```

## Let's try to experience MariaDB

**Starting MariaDB:** Starting MariaDB is as simple as starting any other service on any Linux box and the same as starting the MySQL service.

If you are still on an old *init* based system, then use the following command:

```
$/etc/init.d/mysql start
```

And if you are on a newer *systemd* based platform, then use the command given below:

```
$systemctl start mariadb.service
$systemctl enable mariadb.service - In order to start it
during system boot
```

**Logging in to MariaDB:** Logging in to MariaDB is no different from what you have been doing with MySQL. Just type the *mysql* command and you will get the familiar MySQL CLI environment. Then all the world is yours.

## Features

A few features of MariaDB related to developers are listed below.

- Open and free:** Developed by the community under GPL. Hence no cost involved in royalties.
- Support:** MySQL itself has well-established documentation support, which can also be used for MariaDB. Apart from that, an adequate MariaDB-specific knowledge base is available on the Web.
- Speed:** MariaDB is regarded as one of the fastest databases available, faster even than MySQL.
- Functionality:** Provides support for all MySQL features along with additional new and enhanced features developed by the community.
- Ease of use:** According to user feedback, MariaDB is easy to use, especially with features like flexible syntax.
- Portability:** Provides easy ways to import/export CSV and XML, and is also portable with preinstalled MySQL.
- Scalable:** MariaDB as its parent is ideal for both small as well as large databases.
- Plugins:** Last but not the least, the most important feature of MariaDB is that it provides various storage engines and other third party plugins which cannot be added to MySQL.

## Industry adoption

Having spoken so much about MariaDB, let's look at how the industry has adopted it. Shown below is the list of a few RDBMS platforms that support MariaDB.

**Database Workbench:** This is a software application for development and administration of multiple relational databases.

**DBEdit:** This is a free administration application for MariaDB and other databases.

**HeidiSQL:** This is a free open source client for MySQL on Windows. It supports MariaDB-specific features with the Windows MSI package of MariaDB, beginning with the 5.2.7 release.

**Navicat:** This is a series of proprietary database management applications for Windows, Mac OS X, and Linux.

**phpMyAdmin:** This is a Web-based database management application for MySQL.